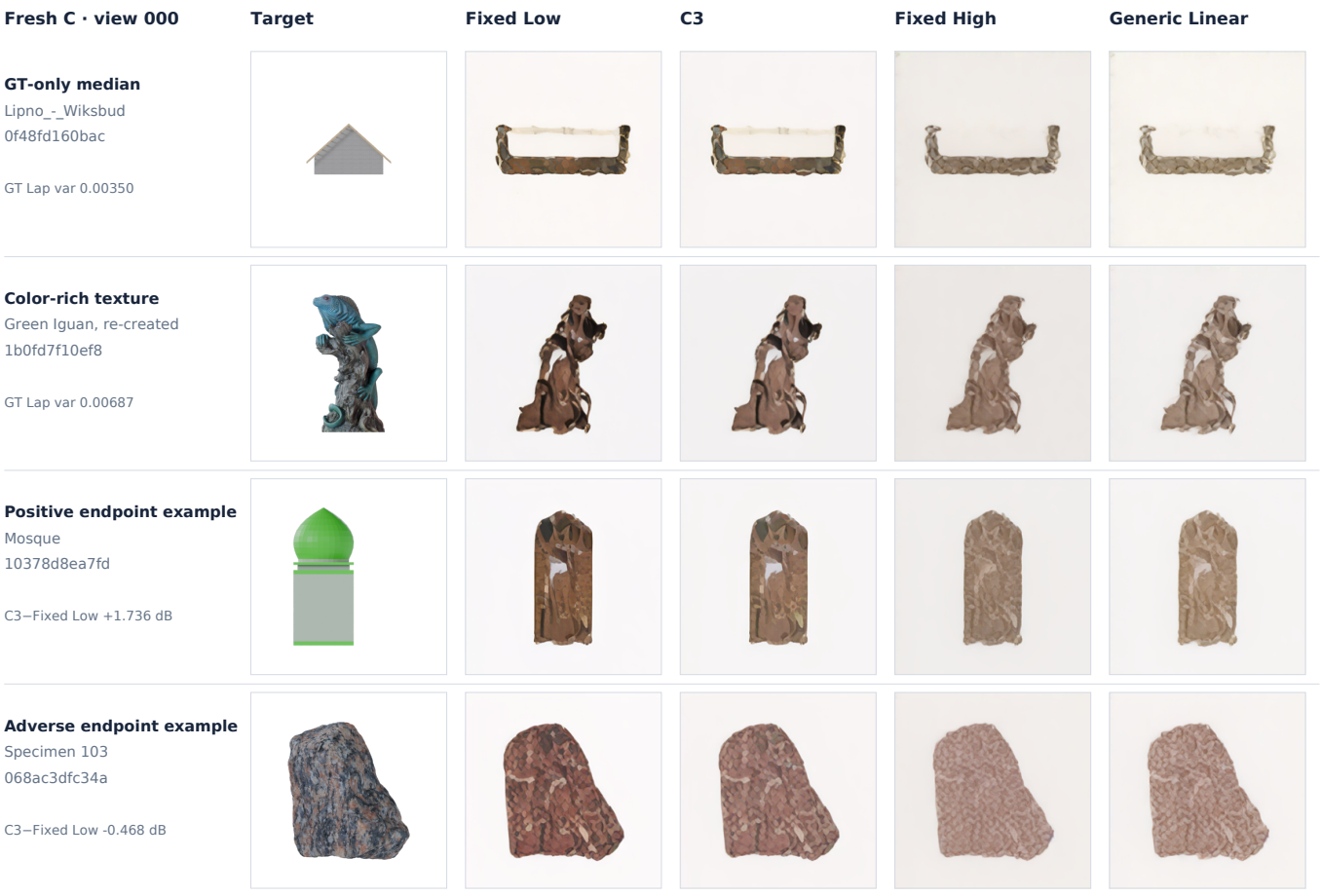


Fig. 2. Fresh C, camera 000. Every row shows Target, Fixed Low, C3, Fixed High and Generic Linear in the same full-frame view. Targets are source RGB conditioning renders, not measured ground-truth albedo. Lipno is the median target-only foreground Laplacian-variance example among the rights-cleared input-selected display set; Green Iguan adds a colorful, textured organic object selected from source properties. Mosque (+1.736 dB) and Specimen 103 (−0.468 dB) are post-outcome selected positive and adverse C3–Fixed Low FG-PSNR examples. These selected rows illustrate endpoint heterogeneity; they do not estimate prevalence or establish a cohort-wide advantage. Complete source identity and credits are in Supplementary Section S9 and the visual selection manifest.

Table 3. Selected paired color-diagnostic contrasts.

Contrast	Mean CIEDE2000 difference [95% CI]	Objects
GFL – No Adapter	−19.654 [−26.370, −13.248]	24/26 lower
LLH – GFL	+3.583 [+0.462, +6.712]	–

The 26 objects are failure-enriched, not a prevalence sample. Negative differences favor the first condition.

a ground-truth VAE encode–decode isolate had CIEDE2000 4.086 and $\Delta a^* \approx -1.35$, compared with 22.032 and +1.977 for GFL. This weakens ordinary VAE round-trip error as the sole explanation for that example, without identifying the complete cause.

LLH–GFL increased mean CIEDE2000 while reducing foreground gradient magnitude, high-frequency energy and color entropy. Lower variation therefore did not imply closer reference appearance. The denoising/runtime isolates and three failed correction candidates remain in Supplementary Section S6; they localize observations but do not validate a cause or repair.

Earlier bake results and calibration checks are reported separately in Supplementary Section S5 and are not pooled with the ten-object cohort. The GeoTex residual branch with an unset scale differs from an explicit Constant 1.0 request under the wrapper caps; we label the latter by its executed setting.

Full-object evidence and its selection. The complete views in Figure 2 and the color failure in Figure 4 use a shared full-frame display for every condition within each object; the existing color diagnostic retains its identical pixel crop. Favorable/adverse C3–GFL examples are retained in Supplementary Section S9. Outcome-selected displays illustrate behav-